



THE CACHACA CASE

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Activity I. Read the following text and discuss:

It was a **dreary** Monday morning when Detective Julia Kendall was called to the scene of a **burglary**. The owner of the house, a **wealthy** businessman, had reported that his **safe** had been broken into and a significant amount of money and jewelry had been stolen.

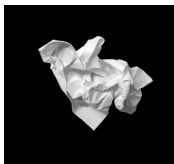


Dreary: gloomy, dull, or uninspiring

Burglary: the act of illegally entering a building and removing valuable objects

Wealthy: having a large amount of money

Safe: made of metal with a lock or combination, used for storing valuable items documents



As she inspected the crime scene, Detective Kendall noticed a piece of paper on the ground near the **safe**. It was torn and **crumpled**, but she could make out a few words: "Meet at the park. Richard."

Crumpled: wrinkled or crushed, as a result of being folded, compressed

She didn't think much about it at first, assuming it was just a note between two partners. But as she **delved** deeper into the investigation, things started to **fall into place**.

Delved: to investigate or explore something thoroughly

Fall into place: to happen as expected

She discovered that the businessman had recently **fired** his assistant, a man named Richard, for **embezzlement**. Richard had been furious about losing his job and had been **overheard** making **threats** to "get revenge" over his former boss.

Fired: to be dismissed or terminated from a job

Embezzlement: the act of stealing money or property

Overheard: to hear something that was not meant for one's ears

Threats: statements or actions that express an intention to harm, damage, or cause trouble

Detective Kendall became convinced that Richard was the **culprit**, but she didn't have enough evidence to prove it. That is, until she received a **tip** from Richard's ex-coworker Douglas, saying that Richard had been seen wearing one of the stolen pieces of jewelry.

Culprit: a person responsible for a crime or wrongdoing.

Tip: a piece of information or advice that is given to someone

With a **search warrant** in hand, Detective Kendall and her team went to Richard's apartment. They found the missing money and jewelry hidden in a false wall, behind a **cupboard** of cachaça bottles, along with the torn note that had led Kendall to suspect Richard in the first place.

Search warrant: a legal document that authorizes law enforcement

Cupboard: a piece of furniture with shelves or drawers used for storing items

When Richard was brought in for questioning, he initially denied everything. But as Detective Kendall presented her evidence, he **broke down** and confessed to the crime. It had been a shock to everyone who knew him, as Richard had always been considered a **trustworthy** and decent member of the community.

Broke down: to lose emotional control and become very upset

Trustworthy: deserving of trust or confidence

As the news spread, people were stunned that someone they had known for years had committed such a **heinous** act. But Detective Kendall knew that it was just another day on the job, and she was already onto the next case.

Heinous: shockingly evil or wicked; abominable or atrocious